

tory in a separate location than the original file version, saving yourself from accidentally overwriting all current files with their older versions.

- ▶ **Select Drive:** It's here that you select the partition from one of the drives which qualify for the feature to be used by File History. Remember that you can select only one drive at a time. File History can't utilize more than one drive at a time. A folder named 'File History' is automatically created on the drive selected by you.
- ▶ **Exclude Folders:** If there are any folders that you want to exclude from being backed up by File History, you can specify them. This rule will apply to any folder added to any library as well as to Desktop, Contact and Favorites folders in your user folder as well.
- ▶ **Advanced Settings:** There are three characteristics of File History you can tame from this screen:
 1. **Frequency of file saves:** By default, File History saves the files every hour. You can change the frequency to anywhere between '10 minutes' to 'Daily'. It goes without saying that higher the frequency of backups by File History, more the disk space utilized.
 2. **Size of offline cache:** This applies to the case when you've selected a network folder on the 'Select Drive' page. It determines how much of the recent backups will be kept locally as cache. The default value is 5% of the disk space, and 20% is just as high as you can go.
 3. **Versions to save:** The default is 'Forever' which means that File History won't delete anything, ever. However keeping the default is a bad idea – you're bound to eventually run out of space. Unless you really have enough space, it's recommended to change it to something more modest such as three months. This should typically be the duration after which you perform that boring manual job of organizing files and ensuring that everything is in order. If you're one of those who take backups regularly, three months should be good otherwise 'Forever' isn't a bad option either, given that fact that you can manually clean up the versions you don't need by clicking the 'Clean up version' link just below this option.

File History is one of those features which we'd truly swear by. Once you start using it, there's no going back. Sure there have been backup programs but when it comes integrated with the OS in a neat and easy to use package, it becomes unbeatable. Although there are many improvements, for some, this alone can be reason enough to purchase Windows 8. File History is available in all versions of Windows 8. 